



ABD has, in the past year, also gone from being an exclusive popular segment player in the whisky category to one with launches in both the prestige and premium categories.

Officer's Choice Blue whisky, its offering in the prestige segment, sold one million cases in the first year of its launch in 2011. It is among the leading whisky brands in its segment in several Indian states with an overall peak share of 8.4 per cent in Fiscal 2020 by sales volume.

On the other hand, ABD made its premium segment debut in 2017 with its twin offerings: Sterling Reserve Blend 10 and Blend 7 which also crossed

one million cases in the first year of launch. Sterling Reserve emerged as the fastest growing spirits brand globally in 2019 (Technopak report 2022)

The way forward

ABD is focused on research and development centred on quality, product innovation, which includes conceptualisation and development, acquiring novel raw materials and cost optimisation. Its research and development facility located at Aurangabad is equipped with instrumentation for testing of raw materials, packaging materials, blend tasting and testing as well as finished product quality. Environmental and social practices and sustainability are emerging to be key focus areas across all parts of

ABD's business and operations. "We had developed sustainable packaging for the Sterling Reserve Limited Edition which won us the Gold at the Design and Packaging Masters 2021," says Basu.

Elaborating further on this, Arun Barik, Executive Director, ABD, says, "Our sustainability initiatives are aimed at zero harm, zero waste and zero discharge. To achieve this vision, quality and compliance controls are being established and revamped right from the supply chain to the value chain. We intend to continue our growth in this area. We intend to reduce our consumption of fossil fuels and increase use of aseptic packaging, implementation of solar energy to power manufacturing operations and reduction in the use of water as part of our distilling and IMFL bottling operations."

Revealing new directions for ABD, Basu says, the company has introduced a broader portfolio in the past few months in the premium, semi-premium and deluxe segments. "We have consciously developed our product portfolio to provide consumers with winning, high-quality brands at various price points. While staying invested in mass-premium which is at the core of our business, we will build on the success of Sterling Reserve with launches of ICONiQ White, Srishti, X&O – all whiskies which will be margin accretive. We are also extending Jolly Roger Rum to newer geographies," Basu concludes.

Awards and accolades

- **Officer's Choice Whisky received the Wines Beers and Drinks Awards in 2018 for the world's largest selling whisky**
- **Sterling Reserve Premium Whisky won the Spiritz Award in 2019 for the fastest growing whisky brand**
- **Officer's Choice Brandy received the IndSpirit Award in 2018 for the best popular brandy**
- **Sterling Reserve Blend 7 Whisky was given the IndSpirit Award in 2018 for the best semi-premium whisky.**
- **Sterling Reserve Blend 7, Kyron Premium Brandy and Officer's Choice Blue were rated as 'Notable Products' at the Superior Taste Award by the International Taste Institute, Brussels in 2021.**
- **Sterling Reserve Blend 10 Whisky, Sterling Reserve Blend 7 Whisky and Kyron Premium Brandy all won gold awards at the prestigious Monde Selection Brussels in 2022.**

